affecting my life, and I certainly needed some help to control that, but I've never seen myself as an alcoholic.

I know it is pretty standard behaviour for an addict to declare that he or she doesn't have a problem. The good folk at Harmony Addictions Clinic, where I went to rehab, certainly drove that point home. In their opinion, if you finish their programme and, say, have two huge drinking sessions a year – two and no more – they still consider you to be an alcoholic. I find that bizarre, to be honest. So if you only drink two out of 365 days, but those two days you go at it hammer and tongs, you have a problem with alcohol? I mean, it's pretty damn harsh to call somebody an alcoholic in that case. That would make just about everyone I've ever played cricket with an alcoholic.

I never spoke to my parents about going into rehab – we've never been a family who discusses anything deep. When my dad found out – he's a sports journalist, so he would've got wind of it early on – he was quite blasé about the whole thing. His take was that it was unrealistic to think Herschelle would never drink again. And besides, he thought it could only have a negative effect on my bubbly personality. Some might call his stance irresponsible, but I think his is a pretty accurate assessment.

Anyway … ja, I thought about it and then I made up my mind to give rehab a try. I checked into Harmony Addictions Clinic in Hout Bay on 4 December 2008. Donné took me in. I chose to have my own room – it was more like a suite, actually, and quite nice too. So in I go, and, as all new 'guests' do, I get the full search. They check every item of clothing in your possession, even your shoes, and also go through your suitcase thoroughly. And then they strip you completely naked to check that you're not hiding anything where the sun don't shine. While it's not the full-on latex rubber-glove number, you *are* basically standing there completely starkers, and a member of the male staff (unfortunately) checks if you have any crack – or whatever your drug of choice may be – up your crack.

Obviously I was like, 'Whoa, mate. No need for that. I don't do drugs. I'm just here for alcohol.' So that was quite embarrassing. Afterwards I went to my room and tried to make myself at home. I had a TV, which was great. Unfortunately I had had to hand in my phone as well – in the first week, you're not allowed any contact with people outside. After that, you're allowed one 10-minute phone call a day. Funny enough, as much as I